Alcaraz's Big Comeback Sends Jodar to the ATP Finals

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Carlos Alcaraz saved two **match points** and fought back to beat Taylor Fritz 6-7 (10-12), 7-5, 6-3 on Friday, November 6. The win sent Alcaraz into the **semi-finals**, and it also booked a place at the ATP Finals for 20-year-old Spaniard Jodar.

Fritz won a tight first set in a **tie-break**. Then he moved a break ahead in the second set, and the match looked lost for Alcaraz. But the 23-year-old Spaniard refused to give up. He saved two **match points**, broke Fritz twice, and tied the match. Then he took charge, moving 3-1 ahead in the final set and finishing with a powerful **forehand**. 'I tried not to let myself down in those difficult moments, to stay strong mentally,' Alcaraz said.

Alcaraz will face either Casper Ruud or Nuno Borges in the **semi-finals**. Jodar's place at the finals in Turin, Italy, is now safe. The event, held from November 15 to 22, features the top eight men's singles players in the world. Jodar will make his **debut** there, as will American Frances Tiafoe, 28.

Jodar only became a full-time professional at the start of 2026. The Madrid-born youngster won three ATP Challenger titles in 2025 and claimed his first ATP Tour title in Marrakech in April 2026.

Word Treasure

match points -- A match point is a point that would win the whole match for one player.

tie-break -- A tie-break is a short extra part of a set that decides the winner when the score is tied.

semi-finals -- The semi-finals are the matches played just before the final to decide who plays for the title.

forehand -- A forehand is a tennis shot hit with the front of the racket hand moving forward.

debut -- A debut is the first time someone takes part in an event.

Background you need

Tennis is a sport where two players hit a ball back and forth over a net, and the player who wins enough games and sets wins the match.

The ATP Finals is a big event at the end of the tennis season for the top eight men's singles players in the world.

Players earn a place there by doing well in matches during the year, so a win like this one can help decide who gets to play.

Break it down

WHO: Carlos Alcaraz, Taylor Fritz, and Jodar

WHAT: Alcaraz saved two match points and beat Fritz, which sent Alcaraz to the semi-finals and booked Jodar a place at the ATP Finals

WHERE: The ATP Finals will be held in Turin, Italy

WHY: Alcaraz's win decided who would take the last places at the ATP Finals, so Jodar's place there is now safe

Why it matters

It shows that staying calm and never giving up can turn a hard game around, just like when you keep trying at school or in sport even when you are losing.

Test what you remember

1. Who did Carlos Alcaraz beat in this match?

(A) Frances Tiafoe
(B) Casper Ruud
(C) Taylor Fritz
(D) Nuno Borges

2. How many match points did Alcaraz save?

(A) Three
(B) Four
(C) One
(D) Two

3. What was the final score of the match?

(A) 6-7 (10-12), 7-5, 6-3
(B) 7-5, 6-3, 6-7 (10-12)
(C) 6-3, 7-5, 6-7 (10-12)
(D) 7-6, 5-7, 3-6

4. Whose place at the ATP Finals did Alcaraz's win help to book?

(A) Jodar
(B) Taylor Fritz
(C) Casper Ruud
(D) Nuno Borges

5. Where will the ATP Finals be held?

(A) Paris, France
(B) Marrakech, Morocco
(C) Turin, Italy
(D) Madrid, Spain

6. How many ATP Challenger titles did Jodar win in 2025?

(A) Four
(B) One
(C) Two
(D) Three

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: D 3: A 4: A 5: C 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Carlos Alcaraz: He said he tried not to let himself down in the difficult moments and to stay strong mentally.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):